

Jeanne Pinay

PhD Candidate in Economics
University of Turin & Collegio Carlo Alberto

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EDUCATION

PhD, Economics 2023–2027

University of Turin and Collegio Carlo Alberto

Research interests: Economic History, Political Economy, Cultural Economics, Development Economics

Advisors: Giovanni Mastrobuoni, Marco Sanfilippo

MSc, Development Economics 2017–2020

University of Florence, *110/110 cum laude*

Final dissertation: *Shocks, Coping Strategies and Food Security in the Context of a Protracted Conflict: The Case of Palestine*

Master-1, International Economics and Development 2015–2016

Università Cattolica del Sacro Cuore, Milan & Université Paris Dauphine-PSL

Erasmus program

BSc, Economics 2012–2015

Université Paris Dauphine-PSL

TEACHING

Quantitative Methods: Causal Inference with Stata (graduate) Spring 2025

Lecturer, University of Turin

Development Economics: Growth, Development and Impact Evaluation (graduate) Fall 2024

Teaching Assistant, University of Turin

RESEARCH-RELATED WORK EXPERIENCE

Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (FAO)

- *Economist*, Rome, Italy Aug 2020–Aug 2023
Agrifood Economics Division (ESA) & Office of Emergencies and Resilience (OER)
- *Data Analyst Fellow*, Jerusalem Oct 2019–Feb 2020
Monitoring & Evaluation Unit (M&E)
- *Research Analyst Intern*, Rome, Italy Aug 2016–Mar 2017
Agrifood Economics Division (ESA)

WORKING PAPERS

The Colonial Roots of Modern Nationalism: The Case of Italy

with M. Broso *Submitted*

Abstract: European empires dominated entire continents for centuries. Yet, the literature on colonial legacies has largely focused on the long-term effects of colonialism in former colonies, overlooking its consequences for the former colonial powers themselves. In this article, we study the effect of Italy's colonial expansion in East Africa on contemporary political outcomes. Using data on all Italian soldiers buried in Eritrea and Ethiopia and the contemporary distribution of surnames across Italy, we construct an index of exposure to colonial wars at the municipality level. To isolate exogenous variation in municipalities' exposure, we exploit the historical geographical distribution of mountain troops of the Italian Army, which were largely deployed in East Africa because of Ethiopia's mountainous territory. We show that exposure to the 1930s colonial campaigns increased support for neo-fascist and nationalist parties in the immediate postwar electoral cycles, and still increases support for far-right parties today. Exploring possible mechanisms, we find that: (i) the effect is amplified in municipalities with a larger presence of Black African immigrants; (ii) far-right

parties obtain larger electoral returns from anti-immigration rhetoric in municipalities with stronger colonial exposure. Taken together, our results suggest that the racial narratives used to justify the colonial expansion may have persisted across generations and continue to shape political attitudes today.

Related project: Interactive maps and time series graphs of electoral results in Italy, 1948–2022

PRE-DOCTORAL PUBLICATIONS

“Impact Evaluation in Humanitarian Contexts: The Joint Resilience Program in Somalia”

with A.P. De la O Campos, B. Davis, and M. D’Errico. *Journal of Development Studies*, forthcoming

“Building Resilience in Conflict Areas: Quasi-experimental Evidence from Borno State in North-East Nigeria”

with T. Brück, W. Stojetz, P. Ronzani, and M. D’Errico. *Journal of African Economies*, forthcoming

“Shocking Social Safety Nets: Evidence from Violence and Drought in North-East Nigeria”

with W. Stojetz, P. Ronzani, M. D’Errico, and T. Brück. *Food Policy*, 2026

“Drivers and Stressors of Resilience to Food Insecurity: Evidence from 35 Countries”

with M. D’Errico, E. Jumbe, and H.A. Luu. *Food Security*, 2023 – Background paper for *The State of Food and Agriculture 2021 (FAO)*

WORK IN PROGRESS

Europenses: The Making of a Christian European Identity in the Middle Ages

with M. Broso

Offshore Oil Discoveries and the Disruption of Artisanal Fisheries

Abstract: Artisanal fishing is crucial for employment, food security, and the sustainability of marine ecosystems. Identifying the factors that threaten this sector is essential for designing efficient and effective policies. In this article, I study the effect of offshore hydrocarbon discoveries – 40 percent of all global hydrocarbon discoveries to date – on artisanal fisheries. Using data on coastal countries from 1950 to 2017, I exploit variation in the plausibly exogenous timing and location of offshore discoveries in a stacked difference-in-differences design. I find that artisanal fishing effort declines steadily, falling to about 20 percent below its pre-discovery level eight years after a discovery. To investigate the mechanisms, I then focus on Senegal, which offers highly granular census data. I estimate a difference-in-differences model comparing fishing municipalities located close to discovery sites with those farther away. Consistent with the cross-country evidence, artisanal fishery employment falls significantly; this decline is largely offset by a rise in deep-sea fishery activity. Using data on fish catches and chlorophyll-a, a proxy for marine conditions, I provide suggestive evidence that fishers reallocate toward deep-sea fishing due to restricted access to fishing grounds and coastal ecosystem degradation. This suggests that existing marine protected areas and inshore exclusive zones may be insufficient to protect artisanal fisheries from the consequences of offshore resource development.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- 2026** European Economic Association Congress (Dublin); European Political Science Association Conference (Prague)
- 2025** 5th Development Economists Meeting (Florence)
- 2024** 4th Development Economists Meeting (Rome)
- 2023** World Bank, IFAD & FAO Joint Conference (Palermo); AGRODEP Annual Conference (Kigali)
- 2022** International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD) Conference (Rome)